The Development and Validation of the Evaluation Involvement Scale for Use in Multi-site Evaluations
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Involvement Scale	Factor*
1. Discussions that focused the evaluation	Planning
2. Identifying evaluation planning team members	Planning
3. Developing the evaluation plan	Planning
4. Developing data collection instruments	Planning
5. Developing data collection processes	Planning
6. Collecting data	Implementation
7. Reviewing collected data for accuracy and/or completeness	Implementation
8. Analyzing data	Implementation
9. Interpreting collected data	Implementation
10. Writing evaluation reports	Implementation
11. Presenting evaluation findings (e.g., to staff, to stakeholders, to an external audience)	Implementation

Question stem: To what extent were you involved in…
Response Options: 1=No 2=Yes, a little 3=Yes, some 4=Yes, extensively N/A=This activity did not take place

*The original thirteen items were submitted to Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA) using principal components analysis and Varimax rotation. The resulting "elbow" in the scree plot indicated that two factors should be retained. In addition, an examination of the Eigen values greater than one supported the decision to retain two factors. The two factors above 1.0 (7.6 and 1.7), explained 72% of the variance. Items that loaded at .4 on a factor and were more than .2 higher than the other factor loading were retained. This rule supported the removal of the following two items:

- Reviewing evaluation reports for accuracy and/or completeness
- Developing future project plans based on evaluation results.

Cronbach's alpha was computed for both factors (planning, alpha=.918; implementation, alpha=.921).

Theoretical Framework: Messick's Unitary Concept of Validity

Validity is "an integrated evaluative judgment of the degree to which empirical evidence and theoretical rationales support the *adequacy* and *appropriateness* of inferences and *actions* based on test scores or other modes of assessment." (Messick, 1989, 1995a, 1995b)

Primary Data Sources

PI & Evaluator Online Survey	**Interviews**	**Literature Review**
Aug 2006 – Jan 2007	Mar 2007 – Apr 2007	Fall 2005 – June 2007
Topic: Involvement and use in four NSF multi-site evaluations.	Topic: Follow-up to survey with two questions related to involvement.	Topic: Participatory evaluation research studies.
Sample Size: 372/810 Response Rate: 46% *Non-respondent study indicated no significant differences in levels of involvement between respondents and non-respondents.	Sample Size: 12 respondents who have various levels of involvement and use.	Scope: 27 empirical and theoretical articles directly related to participatory evaluation.

Key Validity References

Brualdi, A. (1999). *Traditional and modern concepts of validity* (Report No. ED435714). Washington D.C.: ERIC Clearinghouse on Assessment and Evaluation.

Kane, M. T. (1992). Quantitative methods in psychology: An argument-based approach to validity. *Psychological Bulletin, 112*(3), 527-535.

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Messick, S. (1989). Meaning and values in test validation: The science and ethics of assessment. *Educational Researcher, 18*(2), 5-11.

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